# How to Be a Villain

## By Neil Zawacki

## INTRODUCTION

***ACTOR 1:*** *Dracula. Hannibal. Frankenstein,*
***ACTOR 2:*** *The doctor* or *the monster, either applies –*
***ACTOR 1:*** *Fictional villains are so famous all you need to hear are their names, and you know* ***exactly*** *who they are.*
***ACTOR 2:*** *Villains are some of the most memorable characters in fiction. But just how do these super villains get launched into infamy?*
*ACTOR 1: It's How to Be a Villain, a step-by-step guide by Neil Zawacki, that answers all the most urgent questions . . .*
***ACTOR 2:*** *From choosing an evil name, to marketing your brand;*
***ACTOR 1:*** *Finding the perfect evil hideout, to developing an evil masterplan.*
***ACTOR 2:*** *It's cheaper than attending the annual bad guy conference*
***ACTOR 1:*** *And way more fun than being good.*
***ACTOR 2:*** *How to Be a Villain is guaranteed to elicit deep-throated evil laughs across the land!*
***TOGETHER:*** *(evil laughter)*

**ACTOR 1: Step 1: Choosing an Evil Name (Pg 14-16)**

**ACTOR 2:** To get your career launched with flair you'll want a good evil name for yourself. One that is memorable, pithy and short. Choose carefully because this is what the world will know you as throughout time!

**ACTOR 1:** The Normal Name: Believe it or not, you don't always need a big flash name. Trust in your evil deeds, and, should you become terrible enough, that alone can be enough to inspire fear in all humanity. . . *[Updated from Bill Gates and Pat Robertson, you may insert your own real-life villains]* Rudy Giuliani, *(Actor 2 reacts)* OJ Simpson, *(Actor 2 reacts)* Elon Musk. *(Actor 2 reacts)*

**ACTOR 2:** [Or] The Descriptive Name: What makes you so bad? If you like to crush things, for example you might decide to call yourself The Pulverizer. Evil geniuses with multiple limbs might opt for The Octopus.

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**ACTOR 1:** [Or perhaps a more] Sinister Name: Lord FireHammer; Duke IronSkull; Doctor WormBlight -- Let your creativity blossom!

**ACTOR 2: Step 2: Evil Branding (Pg 17)**

Make your new designation echo in the minds of the timid for eons with some sophisticated evil branding. You won't need to consult Madison Avenue; chances are, you can come up with great ideas on your own. [You'll need a]

**ACTOR 1: SLOGAN** – Three to five words that sum up your evil ways in an intimidating fashion. Remember, you're talking directly to your victims, so make your message something they can relate to, such as, "Mercy is Not an Option!" *[add additional examples such as "You Can't Handle the Truth!" "You underestimate the power of the Dark Side!]*

**ACTOR 2:** [And don't forget a] **TRADEMARK GESTURE** -- Whether you leave behind a token of your villainy or howl from a mountaintop each fortnight, consistent delivery of a gesture or symbolic act, in other words a trademark, will help reinforce your name and identity, making it that much more likely that your evil ways will survive in perpetuity. *[Insert a variety of gestures, body stances, entrances/exits here; be creative]*

**ACTOR 1:** [Next] **THE EVIL LAUGH** – A Must-Have **(Pg 23)**

There are a number of excellent ways to enhance your evil persona, from *(in a heavy accent)* feigning a foreign accent to *(assume a physical tick)* exaggerating a physical defect or tick. However, the most essential skill by far is an evil laugh.

**ACTOR 2:** The evil laugh is a defining characteristic of any supervillain, and you will find yourself calling on it quite regularly as you exult in your own wickedness.

**ACTOR 1:** Ha Ha Ha

**ACTOR 2:** Hehe-he-he-he

**ACTOR 1:** Muahahahaha

**ACTOR 2:** Bwah-ha-ha-ha-ha!!!

**TOGETHER:** HAHAHAHAHAHAHAHAHAHAHAHA

**ACTOR 1:** Once you have decided upon a laugh, practice it every day. *(laugh)*

**ACTOR 2:** Take a deep breath, relax, and feel yourself laugh like a crazed hyena. *(laugh)*

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**ACTOR 2:** Learn all its different chortles and inflections, exploring the many ways it can inspire fear.

**TOGETHER:** *(laugh)*

**ACTOR 1:** [And finally] **FASHION FOR THE EVIL-DOER (Pg 122)**

The most agonizing decision of your evil career. What to wear? It may seem wrong, but many people will form ideas about how evil you are based on how you dress and carry yourself.

1. **ACTOR 2:** It's hard to go wrong with classic black. Sinister, foreboding, fashionable yet fearsome, black creates an air of mystery. *(trademark gesture)* Classic black remains THE fashion statement for villains everywhere.
2. **ACTOR 1:** **(Pg 125)** [But] If you spent your childhood hiding in the backyard reading comic books, you probably won't be happy with anything less than the supervillain costume with gimmicks.

   **ACTOR 2:** Be it a green jumpsuit with question marks or an outlandish clown suit that shoots confetti, the gimmicky costume will automatically provide a motif from which you can adopt a personal theme.

   **ACTOR 1:** As you design your costume, take your body type into consideration. Colorful leotards may be high on visual impact, but remember, spandex is a privilege, not a right!
3. **ACTOR 2:** **(Pg 131)** Evil masterminds who posses a magical inclination may want to invest their money in wizard's robes.

   **ACTOR 1:** These sleek garments are ideal for sorcerers providing fashion sensibility and open-air comfort.

   **ACTOR 2:** And they look great with sandals or basic black supervillain boot-socks.

   **ACTOR 1:** You can find them in a wide range of colors, including black and red – avoid white [though] both because of the association with good and because you will look like you're wearing a toga.

**ACTOR 2: Step 3:** [Don't forget a] **Location for Your Lair (Pg 88)**

Every evil mastermind needs a base of operations. Choose your lair carefully. If you have enemies, they will probably show up on your doorstep eventually, so you'll want it to be an

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impressive edifice to your grandeur. Consider . . .

1. **ACTOR 1: (Pg 90)** An Underground Secret Headquarters of Doom. *(trademark gesture)* To the untrained eye the secret entrance looks like nothing more than an isolated shack in the middle of nowhere.

   **ACTOR 2:** But should you take the secret elevator hidden within, all is horribly revealed. An underground headquarters is a diabolical lair of which you can be proud.

   **ACTOR 1:** Popular for their low energy bills, privacy and "only a madman could live here" ambience, *(laugh)* a subterranean lair is an excellent choice indeed.

2. **ACTOR 2: (Pg 92)** The Fake Mountain with a hollow interior is another appealing site. On the outside it looks like any other mountain, but with the flip of a switch you can transform it into a deadly fortress of doom! *(laugh)*

   **ACTOR 1:** The only caveat with the fake mountain is that you should not place it in the middle of a city. For some reason, they are too often noticed there.

3. **ACTOR 2: (Pg 93)** Although considered gimmicky for years, the amusement park lair has seen a resurgence in popularity in recent times.

   **ACTOR 1:** The reason is simple: The décor can easily be transformed into a carnival of horrors, the fun houses laced with booby traps and the hall of mirrors at the end for confronting the heroes.

   **ACTOR 2:** The tunnel of love offers endless possibilities for becoming the tunnel of screams *(scream turning into laughter)*

   **TOGETHER:** Fun for the whole family!

**ACTOR 1: Step 4:** [And Last but Not Least . . . You must have an **Evil Plan**]

**ACTOR 2: (Pg 140)** Have you ever wanted to make a great evil plan, but didn't have the time?

**ACTOR 1:** You're not alone. In fact, many evil men and women struggle with this culminating act. The secret to success is planning ahead.

**ACTOR 2:** The Evil Plan Generator will help you! By identifying your goals, means and target for destruction, the EPG lets you concoct a truly nefarious scheme in a matter of minutes. Simply fill in the blanks! *(See fill-in-the-blank options at the end of the selection – ACTOR 1 reads the*

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*Plan, asking for the Fill-in-the-blank prompt—ACTOR 2 provides the blank option with gusto)*

**(Pg 156) STAGE 1:** To begin, you must first **(ACTION) (TARGET).** This will cause the world to **(REACTION), (DESCRIPTIVE VERB)** by your arrival. Who is this **(NAME)**? Where did they come from? And why do they look so good in **(FASHION)**?

**STAGE 2:** Next, you must **(ACTION) (MONUMENT).** This will all be done from your **(BASE),** a mysterious place of unrivaled dark glory. Upon seeing this, the world will **(REACTION),** as countless hordes of **(HENCHMEN)** hasten to do your every bidding.

**STAGE 3:** Finally, you must **(ACTION)** your **(WEAPON),** bringing about **(DESTINY).** Your name shall become synonymous with **(RANDOM),** and no man will ever again dare **(TRAGIC PAST).** Everyone will bow before your **(POWER),** and the world will have no choice but to **(END RESULT).**

**TOGETHER:** And that's How to be a Villain! *(Evil laughter)*

## SOURCE INFORMATION

***Author: Neil Zawacki***
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## AWARD HISTORY

***2004 National Qualifier***
***2005 National Qualifier***
***2011 National Qualifier***
***2023 National Qualifier***
***KS State Qualifier***

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**(Pg 142-153) STAGE 1:** Fill-in-the-blank Options

| ACTION: | TARGET: | REACTION: |
|---|---|---|
| Kidnap | A Police Chief | Sit up and take notice |
| Clone | A Wealthy Heiress | Swallow nervously |
| Devour | A Military General | Choke on their food |
| Blackmail | Superman | Whisper among themselves |
| Incapaciate | A Wizard's Apprentice | Sense a grave disturbance in the force |
| Seduce | A Town Mascot | Sign up for life insurance policies |
| Expose | A Rock Star | Leave the country |
| Incinerate | The President | (Other) |
| **DESCRIPTIVE VERB:** | **NAME:** | **FASHION:** |
| Amazed | Criminal Mastermind | Classic Black |
| Baffled | Evil Genius | A Business Suit |
| Shocked | Demented Madman | That Gigantic Silver Helmet |
| Terrified | Future Ruler of All Mankind | Spandex |
| Frightened | Destroyer of All That is Good and Nice | An Off-Center Blonde Wig |
| Alarmed | (Other) | A Pink Tutu |
| Bewildered | | (Other) |
| Paralyzed | | |

**STAGE 2:** Fill-in-the-blank Options

| ACTION: | MONUMENT: | BASE: Location of Your Lair |
|---|---|---|
| Seize control of | Mount Rushmore | Medieval Castle |
| Disintegrate | Fort Knox | Corporate Tower |
| Steal | The Grand Canyon | Underground Secret Headquarters of Doom |
| Poison | The Pyramids of Giza | Desert Island |
| Smash | The Opera House in Sydney | Abandoned Warehouse |
| Sabotage | The Internet | Ancient Tomb |
| Obliterate | The Pacific Ocean | Space Station |
| Vaporize | The Moon | Amusement Park |
| (Other) | | (Other) |
| **REACTION:** | | **HENCHMEN:** |
| Scream | | Corporate Cronies |
| Faint | | Winged Monkeys |
| Tremble | | Robot Warriors |
| Give up | | Ninjas |
| Weep uncontrollably | | Ailen Life Forms |
| Run away | | Demented Clowns |
| Die in a way you just don't want to think about | | English Teachers |

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| | |
|---|---|
| Fall into catatonic trances | Zombies |

**STAGE 3:** Fill-in-the-blank Options

| ACTION: | WEAPON: | DESTINY: |
|---|---|---|
| Reveal to the world | Corporate Takeover | Pain, suffering, the usual |
| Unleash | Armies of Destruction | Something really, really bad |
| Covertly move | Doomsday Device | The return of Conway Twitty |
| Release | Secret Death Ray | Global Climate Change |
| Send forth | Needlessly Big Weather Machine | The end of chocolate cake |
| Let Loose | Blow Up Clown Hammer | The demise of the Internet |
| Tauntingly wave | Super Loud Rock Music | The return of Covid-19 restrictions |
| Activate | (Other) | (Other) |
| (Other) | | |
| **RANDOM:** | **TRAGIC PAST:** | **POWER:** |
| Fuzzy bunnies | Beat you up | Supreme Might |
| Shenanigans | Call you names | Cunning Intelligence |
| Skullduggery | Roll his/her eyes | Dashing Good Looks |
| Mealworms | Interrupt you | Superior Nasal Power |
| Dry Heaves | Tak your lunch money | Unmatched Physical Prowess |
| Eating Brussel Sprouts | Refuse to be your prom date | X-Ray Vision |
| (Other) | (Other) | Power of Invisibility |

**END RESULT:**
Elect you ruler for life
Give you control of the planet
Send you all their money
Name you Man/Woman of the Year
Erect a gigantic statue of you
Restore your credit rating
(Other)

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